

BLAMO CLOSING

THE SPOUSE OBJECTION PLAYBOOK



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Ten respectful closes for “I need to ask my spouse”—
word-for-word scripts and the delivery behind them.

The Spouse Objection Playbook

“I need to ask my spouse” is one of the most common objections in automotive sales. Sometimes it is a genuine partnership decision. Sometimes it is a polite way to slow the deal down. The key is to respect the spouse’s role while finding out which one you’re dealing with—and this playbook gives you ten respectful ways to do exactly that.

HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

Work one close per shift. Say the scripts out loud until they sound like you, adapt the brackets to the real customer, and never read from the page in front of a customer. Use the checklist on each page to grade yourself after every real attempt.

THE HONESTY RULE

Never say something untrue. If you offer to hold a vehicle, hold it. If you promise a call, call. The spouse may never be in the room—but they will hear about how you treated the person who was.

THE CORE PRINCIPLE

Empathy first, curiosity second. Rather than trying to overcome the objection immediately, find out whether the spouse is the true decision-maker or whether another concern—price, payment, trade value, or uncertainty—is hiding behind “I need to ask my spouse.” Once you know the real concern, you can address it respectfully.

7-DAY PRACTICE PLAN

- Day 1: learn the Partnership Close cold—it’s your default.
- Day 2: practice “What’s Their Concern?” and the Information Close.
- Day 3: role-play the call/FaceTime offer out loud.
- Day 4: run the Permission Close and the Test Close.
- Day 5: practice the Reservation Close—honestly, only when you can hold the car.
- Day 6: soften your delivery on the Reality Check and the Future Pace.
- Day 7: full role-play with a teammate; grade each other on the checklists.

The Ten Closes

01 The Partnership Close

GOAL

Honor the partnership without losing momentum—and isolate whether anything else is holding the deal back.

WHEN TO USE IT

The first time you hear the spouse objection. It validates the customer's position before you ask anything, which keeps them from getting defensive.

WHAT TO SAY

"I completely understand—you should make big decisions together. Just so I know how to help, if your spouse were sitting here and loved everything about the vehicle, is there anything else that would keep you from moving forward today?"

WHY IT WORKS

It does two jobs at once. It treats the spouse as part of the decision, and it separates the spouse objection from every other concern. If the answer is "no, nothing else," you know exactly what you're working with. If the answer is "well, the payment's a little high," you just found the real objection.

CHECKLIST

- Validate the partnership before asking anything.
- Deliver the "if your spouse loved it" question exactly.
- Listen for whatever else comes out—that's the real objection.

PUT IT INTO PRACTICE TODAY

Say the script out loud five times. Then change the vehicle, the price, and the customer's name—keep the structure identical.

02 The “What’s Their Concern?” Close

GOAL

Turn a vague “I need to ask my spouse” into one specific question you can answer right now.

WHEN TO USE IT

When the customer is vague and you need information. Most customers have a fair idea what their spouse will ask—get it on the table.

WHAT TO SAY

“Absolutely. What do you think their biggest question or concern will be? Maybe we can answer it now so you’re both comfortable.”

WHY IT WORKS

You stop guessing and start helping. The customer becomes your ally in answering the spouse’s concern, and the real question comes out of the shadows.

CHECKLIST

- Ask for the spouse’s biggest concern, specifically.
- Answer it directly and truthfully.
- Ask whether that settles it for them.

PUT IT INTO PRACTICE TODAY

Role-play it with a teammate until you can ask for the spouse’s concern without sounding like you’re fishing.

03 The Involvement Close

GOAL

Bring the spouse into the conversation on the spot—with their permission.

WHEN TO USE IT

When the customer seems open and the spouse is a phone call away. Offer it as a service, not a pressure play.

WHAT TO SAY

“Would it make sense to give them a quick call or FaceTime? I’d be happy to answer any questions directly.”

WHY IT WORKS

Objections shrink when the real decision-maker hears honest answers from you in the moment. And if the customer says no to a call, that tells you something too.

CHECKLIST

- Offer the call or FaceTime; don’t insist.
- Be ready to answer questions directly and honestly.
- Keep it helpful—the spouse is not the enemy.

PUT IT INTO PRACTICE TODAY

Pick one customer this week and make the call-or-FaceTime offer. Notice how differently the conversation goes.

04 The Permission Close

GOAL

Find out whether the spouse is the only obstacle between you and a yes.

WHEN TO USE IT

When the customer has already signaled they like the vehicle. It is a clean, low-pressure test of how close you are.

WHAT TO SAY

"If your spouse says yes, are you ready to move forward today?"

WHY IT WORKS

This helps determine whether the spouse is the only obstacle. A clear "yes" means the deal is one conversation away. A "well..." means there is a second objection hiding—and you now know to go looking for it.

CHECKLIST

- Ask the exact question after they've shown real interest.
- Note the hesitation, not just the words.
- Follow up with the Reality Check if they hesitate.

PUT IT INTO PRACTICE TODAY

Ask the question on your next live opportunity. Write down the exact words of the answer you get.

05 The Information Close

GOAL

Give the couple what they need to decide—and look like the person who helped them decide.

WHEN TO USE IT

When the customer seems genuinely unsure what the spouse will need. Put yourself on the spouse's side of the table.

WHAT TO SAY

"I want you both to feel confident. What information would help them make the decision?"

WHY IT WORKS

It positions you as the helper, not the seller. The information you hand over goes home with the customer and does your selling for you.

CHECKLIST

- Ask what information the spouse needs.
- Provide it written, itemized, and honest.
- Include your contact info for follow-up questions.

PUT IT INTO PRACTICE TODAY

Gather one real example of information you could hand a couple tonight—payment breakdown, warranty, or ownership costs.

06 The Reservation Close

GOAL

Keep the vehicle available while they talk—and measure how serious they are.

WHEN TO USE IT

Only when the vehicle is genuinely in limited supply and you can actually hold it. Never use it as a fake deadline.

WHAT TO SAY

“I understand. Since this is the one you like, would you like us to hold it while you talk with your spouse so someone else doesn’t purchase it first?”

WHY IT WORKS

It is a real service when inventory is tight. And the customer’s answer tells you how committed they are—“yes, hold it” means they want this car.

CHECKLIST

- Offer only if you can honor the hold.
- Confirm how they want to be reached with the answer.
- Note the time limit of the hold and stick to it.

PUT IT INTO PRACTICE TODAY

Check today’s inventory: which vehicles could you honestly hold, and for how long? Practice the offer on one of them.

07 The Reality Check Close

GOAL

Gently test whether the spouse is the real reason—without confronting the customer.

WHEN TO USE IT

When you suspect the spouse is a cover for something else, or when the deal keeps circling back to the same stall.

WHAT TO SAY

“Is it really about talking it over with your spouse, or is there something else that’s giving you pause? I don’t want to make assumptions.”

WHY IT WORKS

Asked with genuine curiosity, it gives the customer permission to name the real concern—it invites honesty without being confrontational. Most people will take the opening.

CHECKLIST

- Ask it softly, without edge.
- Go silent and let them answer.
- Whatever they name, address it respectfully.

PUT IT INTO PRACTICE TODAY

Run the Reality Check once with a teammate who plays a stalling customer. Keep your tone neutral the whole time.

08 The Future Pace Close

GOAL

Make the “go for it” conversation at home as easy as possible.

WHEN TO USE IT

When the customer is genuinely going to talk to their spouse. Help them picture the win.

WHAT TO SAY

“When you talk to them tonight and they say, ‘Go for it,’ what’s the next step? Should I have everything ready so it’s quick and easy?”

WHY IT WORKS

You are planning the yes with them, not against them. It also gives you a concrete reason to follow up tomorrow—and permission to be ready.

CHECKLIST

- Help them picture the conversation going well.
- Offer to have paperwork and numbers ready.
- Agree on a specific follow-up time.

PUT IT INTO PRACTICE TODAY

End your next spouse-conversation by asking “should I have everything ready?” and set the follow-up time.

09 The Test Close

GOAL

Measure how sold the customer really is—a fast, honest temperature check.

WHEN TO USE IT

Any time you are not sure where you stand. It is one question, and the answer tells you the size of the remaining gap.

WHAT TO SAY

“On a scale of 1 to 10, how sold are you on this vehicle?”
If they say 8-10: “What’s keeping it from being a 10?”

WHY IT WORKS

An 8 or 9 with a named reason gives you the exact objection to solve. A 5 tells you the vehicle or the deal is not right yet—stop closing and start listening.

CHECKLIST

- Ask the question exactly as written.
- If 8-10, ask what keeps it from a 10.
- If lower, ask what it would take to get to a 10.

PUT IT INTO PRACTICE TODAY

Run the 1-to-10 question on three customers this week. Log every answer and what it told you.

10 The Gentle Close

GOAL

Close the day well, even if the customer walks out to talk it over.

WHEN TO USE IT

When the customer is leaving—and when you want to be the person they come back to.

WHAT TO SAY

“I respect that you want to make this decision together. My goal isn’t to pressure you—it’s to make sure when you leave today, you have everything you and your spouse need to make the best decision.”

WHY IT WORKS

Some deals happen tonight, some next week, some with a spouse who was never asked the right questions. This close keeps you trusted either way—and trusted is who they come back to.

CHECKLIST

- Say it sincerely, without a scripted tone.
- Hand over the information they need.
- Set a specific next touchpoint.

PUT IT INTO PRACTICE TODAY

Send one customer home with a written summary of the deal and a warm, genuine send-off. Then follow up when you said you would.

Real Objection or Just a Delay?

The most effective approach is usually a combination of empathy and curiosity. Rather than trying to overcome the objection immediately, find out whether the spouse is the true decision-maker or whether another concern—price, payment, trade value, or uncertainty—is hiding behind “I need to ask my spouse.” Once you know the real concern, you can address it respectfully.

FOUR SIGNALS THAT TELL YOU WHICH ONE YOU’RE FACING

- The customer keeps circling back to payment or trade value—the spouse may be a cover for a money concern. Use the Partnership Close to pull it out.
- The customer has no idea what the spouse will say—it’s a genuine partnership decision. Use the Involvement Close or the Information Close.
- The customer avoids the question and looks for the door—likely a delay. Use the Reality Check, softly.
- The customer says “they always let me decide”—a delay tactic. Use the Permission Close and the Test Close.

THE GROUND RULE

You never win by arguing with a spouse who isn’t in the room. You win by making sure the customer and the spouse have everything they need to say yes.

Quick Reference

1. Partnership — validate the partnership, then isolate any other concern.
2. What's Their Concern? — get the spouse's real question on the table.
3. Involvement — offer a quick call or FaceTime.
4. Permission — is the spouse the only obstacle?
5. Information — give them what they need to decide.
6. Reservation — hold it, honestly, if you can.
7. Reality Check — gently test what's really going on.
8. Future Pace — make the home conversation easy.
9. Test — "on a scale of 1 to 10, how sold are you?"
10. Gentle — leave them with everything and earn the return.

WHERE TO GO NEXT

Explore The Sales Rep Starter Kit for the five core closes, The 10 Steps of the Sale for the in-store floor process, and The 10 Steps to the Internet Sale for online leads. Blamo Closing training is practical, honest, and built for the work in front of you.